

Understanding Benefits, Balances, Referrals, and Notes

Quick reference for reading and managing a referral

1 Referral Status Glossary

A referral moves through these statuses over its lifetime, roughly in this order:

Status	What It Means
New	Referral has been created and is awaiting approval.
Approved	The system recognizes the referral but it hasn't been assigned to a local provider yet.
Assigned to Provider	A provider was found in the service area and alerted (they have 3 days to respond).
Accepted by Provider	The provider has accepted — contact info can be shared with the member.
Unable to Contact	The provider couldn't reach the member after 3 attempts.
Member Declined Services	The member declined the provider that reached out.
Completed	All rate types have been invoiced and billed for the service.
Closed	The service was refunded and the referral is now inactive.

A provider's phone number only becomes visible once the status reaches Accepted by Provider.

2 Referral Narrative

Every referral has a Narrative field where free-text context lives — most importantly, whether it's a one-time service or an ongoing/monthly authorization.

Check the narrative before assuming an end-of-month expiration date means services have ended — it may just be a scheduled monthly renewal.

3 Note Types — At a Glance

Every note needs a Note Type. Here's what each group is for:

Note Type	When to Use It
General	Default for most day-to-day call center actions — when in doubt, use this.
Visit Scheduled Within 1 Week / 2 Weeks / 1 Month	Log an upcoming visit and its timeframe.
Member Outreach in Progress (Contact Attempts) / Unable to Contact Member	Track attempts to reach the member.
Member Declined Services / Member Request to Delay Services	Document a member-side decision.
Unable to Staff	No provider was available to take the referral.
Provider Outreach – Sent Email / Left Message / Sent Text	Track how you reached out to a provider.
Status Change / Escalation	Note a manual status update, or flag a referral for follow-up attention.

4 Encounters & Service Tasks

An Encounter is created each time a provider delivers the service — it's what moves a referral's balance from Allowed toward Used. Remaining is what's left before a new referral or authorization is needed.

Before an encounter can be marked complete, the provider confirms a set of Service Tasks — these vary by service. For an install service, that typically means:

- Installation Completed (required)
- Provider Invoice Number (required)
- Total Points Billed (required)

A bill-pay service, for example, might ask for a payee name instead — the required confirmations always match what that specific service needs.

5 Quick Field Definitions

Field	What It Means
Source	How the referral came in — Portal, eFax, or phone. Useful for tracing the original request.
Plan Code/Option	Which benefit plan and coverage option this referral falls under.
Effective Period	The date range this authorization is valid. Referrals outside this window aren't covered.
Key Dates	Date Received, Date Assigned, Date Accepted, and Date Declined (if applicable) — track a referral's progress toward a provider.